

Grammar

Reported Speech — Statements & Tense Back-shift

When we report a statement, the reporting verb (said, told) is usually in the past, so the tense of the original statement moves one step back into the past: present simple → past simple, present continuous → past continuous, past simple → past perfect, will → would, can → could.

Bir ifadeyi aktarırken, aktaran fiil (said, told) genellikle geçmiş zamanda olduğu için, orijinal cümlelerin zamanı bir adım geriye kayar: geniş zaman → geçmiş zaman, şimdiki zaman → geçmiş zamanın hikayesi, geçmiş zaman → miş'li geçmiş (had + V3), will → would, can → could.

When? We use reported speech to tell someone what another person said, without quoting their exact words — very common in sports news reports and interview summaries.

Reported speech, başka birinin söylediklerini onun tam kelimelerini alıntılamadan aktarmak için kullanılır — spor haberlerinde ve röportaj özetlerinde çok sık görülür.

Positive

- Subject + said/told (object) + (that) + clause with back-shifted tense

Negative

- Subject + said + (that) + subject + did not/had not + verb

Question

- Not used for statements — see reporting questions in a later theme.

Short answers

- He said he was tired.
- She told me she had trained hard.

Common mistakes

- ~~He said he is tired.~~ → **He said he was tired.**
- ~~She told that she won the race.~~ → **She said that she had won the race.**

1. "I am ready for the match," she said. → She said she _____ ready for the match.

2. "We trained all summer," the team said. → The team said they _____ all summer.

3. "I will score a goal," the striker said. Reported speech:

- a. The striker said he will score a goal.
- b. The striker said he would score a goal.
- c. The striker said he scored a goal.
- d. The striker says he would score a goal.

4. "I can't play today," he said. → He said he can't play today. — *True / False*

5. "The referee made a mistake," the coach said. (*The coach said...*)

6. Put the words in order: he / said / tired / was / the coach

7. "I am watching the match," she said. → She said she _____ the match.

8. "We have won three championships," the captain said proudly. (*The captain said...*)

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9. "I could not train yesterday because of my injury," the athlete said. Reported speech:

- a. The athlete said she could not train the day before because of her injury.
- b. The athlete said she cannot train yesterday because of her injury.
- c. The athlete said she could not train yesterday because of her injury.
- d. The athlete says she could not train the day before because of her injury.

Reported Speech — Pronouns, Time Expressions & Reporting Verbs

In reported speech, pronouns change to match the reporter's point of view (I → he/she, my → his/her, we → they), and time/place expressions shift away from the moment of speaking (today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the day before, here → there). We also choose the reporting verb carefully: 'say' does not take a personal object (say something), while 'tell' needs one (tell someone something).

Reported speech'te zamirler, aktaran kişinin bakış açısına göre değişir (I → he/she, my → his/her, we → they); zaman/yer ifadeleri de konuşma anından uzaklaşacak şekilde değişir (today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the day before, here → there). Ayrıca aktaran fiil dikkatle seçilir: 'say' kişisel bir nesne almaz (say something), 'tell' ise bir nesneye ihtiyaç duyar (tell someone something).

When? We use these changes whenever the reporting happens at a different time or place from the original statement — for example, a journalist reporting a coach's comments a day after they were made.

Bu değişiklikler, aktarma işlemi orijinal ifadenin söylendiği zamandan veya yerden farklı bir zaman/yerde yapıldığında kullanılır — örneğin bir gazetecinin, bir antrenörün yorumlarını ertesi gün aktarması gibi.

Positive

- Subject + said/told (object) + (that) + clause with adjusted pronouns & time/place words

Negative

- Subject + said/told + (that) + subject + did not/had not + verb (adjusted pronouns & time/place words)

Question

- Not covered in this point — see statement patterns above.

Short answers

- He told me he was training then.
- They said they had played there.

Common mistakes

- ~~She said me she was tired.~~ → **She told me she was tired.**
- ~~He said he will play here tomorrow.~~ → **He said he would play there the next day.**

1. "I feel great," the athlete said. → The athlete said _____ felt great.

2. "We will train tomorrow," the coach said. → The coach said they would train _____.

3. "My team played well here," the captain said. Reported speech:

- a. The captain said his team had played well here.
- b. The captain said his team had played well there.
- c. The captain said my team had played well there.
- d. The captain said his team plays well there.

4. "I saw the match yesterday," she told me. → She told me she had seen the match yesterday. — *True / False*

5. "I will meet you here tomorrow," the reporter said. (*The reporter said...*)

6. Put the words in order: the coach / his / team / said / had trained / hard

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7. "We won this championship last year, and we will win it again next year," the captain told the fans. (*The captain told the fans...*)

8. Which sentence correctly reports: "I am not playing well this season," the striker admitted.

- a. The striker admitted he is not playing well this season.
- b. The striker admitted he was not playing well that season.
- c. The striker admitted he was not play well that season.
- d. The striker admits he was not playing well this season.